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Conga Upgrades

Forsys Playbook

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1.0 Introduction

Conga is a comprehensive Quote-to-Cash (QTC) solution helping customers automate Quoting/Proposal, Contract Lifecycle Management (CLM), Billing, Order Management & Revenue Management processes. Conga is built native on Salesforce.

Customers purchase Conga packages to automate their business processes, enable and enhance business models, and grow their revenue. They choose module (s) based on the business need and that are suitable for their line of business. They also hire a System Integrator to set up, configure and customize these application packages for their business needs.

System Integrators follow a standard software implementation process & methodologies to configure the system to customer needs:

- Discover existing (AS-IS) customer-specific business processes
- Identify and define future state business processes (TO-BE)
- Document detailed requirements
- Analyze and design the system to meet their future state requirements
- Identify the gaps between what package supports and what customer is envisioning a future state
- Identify the list of customizations that need to be performed on the standard application packages
- Build the system – configure, customize, and integrate
- Test the systems thoroughly to validate & ensure that the systems meet customer requirements
- Train the users on the new system
- Get the system ready for users

The following playbook is created based on:

- Best practices for performing managed package upgrades on Salesforce
- Forsys' experiences in upgrading Conga and related packages for several medium/large customers for Configure-Price-Quote (CPQ), CLM, Billing, Ecommerce & Revenue Management

2.0 Understanding Types of Upgrades

Salesforce managed package upgrades can be classified as (a) Technical and (b) Functional. Technical Upgrades will ensure customers are using the latest version of the managed packages (including objects, application code, etc). This will help customers to have the latest versions of the software installed on Salesforce. **Salesforce highly recommends all its customers upgrade their packages to the latest versions to minimize their support and maintenance costs.**

Functional Upgrades will ensure customers are leveraging the latest features and functionality incorporated into the software to support additional business processes. This follows the standard implementation process & methodology (as described above). Additionally, this process involves conducting detailed gap analysis, reversing customizations, implementing new features and functionality as required to support their business.

3.0 Technical Upgrade Process

Review the install-base to identify the list of customers who do not have the latest version of the Conga packages. Document the list of modules that customers installed and their versions.

3.1 Upgrade Presentation

Prepare a customer presentation detailing the list of new features and functionality included in each of the modules (refer to the release notes or product documentation for the release). Include the benefits and justification to upgrade the packages. Document the high-level upgrade process and estimated timeline.

3.2 Customer Engagement

Identify the customers who have Conga packages older than two releases. Identify its Conga Account Manager or Conga Customer Success Manager. Initiate a call with the customer and share the details of the latest release, justify the urgency to upgrade to the latest version and high-level process for the upgrade. Also, share the discovery questionnaire with the customer.

Discovery Questionnaire

Share the discovery questionnaire (referred to as Forsys-Upgrade-Assessment-Matrix) with the customer and schedule a session to review their responses.

- The key point of contact from Business or IT who is managing/supporting the business operations
- List of modules implemented
- Timelines of go-live
- List of customizations
- Changes since go-live
- List of test scenarios
- Last upgrade – any documentation and key errors post-upgrade
- List of issues or enhancement requirements from Business
- Changes to product & pricing models since go-live

3.3 Technical Upgrade Assessment

The Technical Upgrade will ensure the customer will have the latest Conga packages installed. Anyhow, a careful assessment is needed to estimate the test coverage when the packages are upgraded. So, start with a primary discovery questionnaire to gather basic details from the customer and then fill in the assessment matrix that includes the features & functionality used by the customer and the extent of customizations done to base modules.

3.3.1 Forsys Assessment Matrix

Upon the completion of responses to the discovery questionnaire, determine the testing coverage and complexity based on the following key metrics provided by the customer.

	Low	Medium	High
Business Flows	New & Renewal; Add Ons	Swaps, Upgrades, Addons	Custom Flows, Partner Quoting
Number of Regions	1 (ex: US)	<=2 (ex: US, Canada)	>2
Product Lines	<=5	<=10	>10
Product Attributes	<=25	<50	>50
Product Rules	<25	<75	>75
Bundle levels	1	<=2	>2
Pricing Models	2 (ex: per unit, recurring)	<=4 (ex: per unit, tiered, usage, service)	>4
Pricelists	<=2	<=5	>5
Number of Currencies	1	<=3	>3
Approval Processes	1	<=2	>2
Number of Proposal Templates	<=2	<=4	>4
Proposal Output Language	1	<=2	>3
Reporting	Base reports	Few reports Customized	Many reports customized
Partner Quoting	Not Implemented	Base functionality	Customized
ECommerce	Not Implemented	Not Implemented	Implemented
Integration	Not Integrated with ERP	Order Integration with ERP	Integrated with several boundary systems
Date of the last upgrade	Older by 2 releases	Older by 3 to 5 releases	Older by 5+ releases
Customizations (Configuration, Pricing, Workflow, Templates, Approvals, Others)	No Customizations	Minimal Customizations (less than 2 areas)	More than 2 areas

3.3.2 Customer Readiness

Customer readiness is a critical factor for the technical upgrade process. It is usually categorized as High, Medium & Low. **If the customer has all the testing scenarios, test scripts and test data documented, then it substantially reduces the upgrade timelines.**

High

- The Solution Design Documents (along with the list of customizations) are updated to the latest changes to the production environment
- Test scenarios, Test scripts & Test data is the latest and is available
- No dependent project is in progress that impacts the upgrade
- Testing environments are available for Quality Assurance (QA) and User Acceptance Testing (UAT).
- A dedicated team available to complete the test scenarios
- One Point of Contact from Customer

Medium

- The Solution Design Documents (along with the list of customizations) are not updated to the latest changes to the production environment; the customer needs additional time to determine the latest changes to the production environment
- Test scenarios, Test scripts & Test data is not the latest; the customer needs some time to determine/document the latest changes to the production
- A dependent project is in progress that impacts the upgrade; additional analysis is needed to assess the impact of the upgrade
- Testing environments are not available for QA and UAT immediately
- A dedicated team is not available to complete the test scenarios; the customer COE team can document the test scenarios for Forsys resources to complete testing
- One Point of Contact from Customer

Low

- The Solution Design Documents (along with the list of customizations) are not available
- Test scenarios, Test scripts & Test data are not available
- Multiple dependent projects are in progress that impacts the upgrade
- Need to request for provisioning the testing environments
- Current resources are busy; resources need to be identified (from Forsys or another partner) to complete the test scenarios
- One Point of Contact from Customer

3.3.3 Estimated Timeline

Upgrade timelines are based on the complexity of the implementation (refer to assessment matrix) and customer readiness. The following matrix shows high-level estimates for the time taken to complete the technical upgrade process.

		Implementation Complexity		
		Low	Medium	High
Customer Readiness	High	2 Weeks	4 Weeks	6 Weeks
	Medium	4 Weeks	6 Weeks	8 Weeks
	Low	6 Weeks	9 Weeks	12 Weeks

3.3.4 Scheduling Upgrade

After the timeline is determined and agreed by the customer:

- mobilize & identify resources on both sides
- publish the Upgrade plan
- validate checklists
- Upgrade packages and test thoroughly
- conduct UAT to gather business sign-offs
- deploy in a production environment

3.3.5 Managing Upgrade

Refer to Conga reference documentation for detailed upgrade instructions. Forsys will provide an CONGA Upgrade Documentation (based on analysis, observations, test results, changes,etc)

4.0 Functional Upgrade Process

The initial customer engagement process is similar to the technical upgrade. Anyhow, the Functional Upgrade process involves detailed gap analysis that involves:

- discovery of customizations
- new features and functionality
- de-customization
- implementation plan, design, development, testing and deployment

The schedule and timelines of the functional upgrades are determined based on the discovery and gap analysis.

5.0 Tools

Forsys is in the process of developing assessment tools that determine the complexity of the implementation.

6.0 Testing Automation

Testing is the most critical factor for the upgrade projects; detailed regression suits are available for standard (out of the box) features & functionality. Anyhow, these test suits need to be configured based on the test scenarios, test data and level of complexity of the customer implementation.

7.0 Roles & Responsibilities

The following roles and responsibilities are involved in the Upgrade projects.

Customer Roles	Conga Roles	Forsys Roles
• Project Manager • Business Analyst • Quality Analysts (optional)	• Customer Engagement team • Customer Success Manager / Customer Support Partner (optional) • Account Manager (optional)	• Business Analyst • Conga Developer • Quality Analyst (optional) • Test Automation Engineer (optional)

8.0 Best Practices

Forsys highly recommends customers against customizing packages and leveraging the features & functionality supported in the package. Customization is recommended only when a feature or functionality is not available in the package. Anyhow, the following are the key learnings and best practices for Conga Upgrades.

- **Need a single Point of Contact (POC)** from the customer (either from IT or from Business Operations)
- Full Sandbox environment for upgrade & testing.
- POC to review Release Documentation and discuss the known issues with the customer and their impact
- Customer to provide Documentation for:

    - solution design for the original implementation and subsequent changes
    - list of customizations
    - **test scenarios, cases and data (mandatory)**
- **Automation Testing Strategy**
    - Automation for standard regression test scenarios
    - Manual Testing anywhere the rules and expressions are involved; anything customized
- Demos and UAT from the customer
- Identification of pain points
    - Support cases / Critical issues
- Gap analysis for Functional Upgrades
    - Identify customized features that need to be rolled back
    - Identify new features that improve the user experience or address a pain point
- Product-related issues need to be reviewed by the Conga customer support team

9.0 References

- Conga Release Notes and Upgrade documentation
- Installed Conga Packages

Need more information?
Send us your questions at
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